- Nuclear weapon testing and explosion (Nuclear fallout). The fall out contains radioactive substances such as strontium-90, caesium-137, iodine-131, etc.
- Radiation therapy and direct exposures to radiation for diagnostic purposes (e.g., X-rays), chemotherapy, etc.

Natural Sources of Radioactive pollution

- They include cosmic rays from space and terrestrial radiations from radionuclides present in earth's crust such as radium-224, uranium-238, thorium-232, potassium-40, carbon-14, etc.

76.

- Burning of plastic in garbage dumps release highly toxic and poisonous gases like carbon monoxide, carbon dioxide, phosgene, dioxins and other poisonous chlorinated compounds.
- Toxic solid residue left after burning remains in the soil. The harmful gases enter soils through chemical cycles.

77.

- Dioxin is a pollutant released by plastics that may get released due to improper disposal of e-waste as e-waste also contains plastic.
- Heptachlor is an insecticide.
- Strontium is a radioactive pollutant.

78.

- Itai-itai disease first reported from Japan in 1965 was attributed to cadmium contamination in water and rice caused by the discharge of effluents from a zinc smelter into a river.
- Chronic arsenic poisoning causes melanosis and keratosis (dark spots on the upper chest, back and arms are known as melanosis. The next stage is keratosis in which palms become hard) and leads to loss of appetite, weight, diarrhoea, gastrointestinal disturbances and skin cancer.
- In Japan, mass mercury poisoning (Minamata disease) was observed in the 1960s, caused by eating fish from Minamata Bay which was contaminated with methyl mercury.

79.

- Only denitrification converts nitrates to nitrogen and makes it available to add to atmosphere.